



Manage and monitor innovative tourism programs and projects

D2.TGA.CL6.03

D2.TRM.CL9.10

Assessor Manual



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Project Base

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Competency Based Assessment (CBA) – An Introduction for Assessors

Assessment is the process of identifying a participant's current knowledge, skills and attitudes sets against all elements of competency within a unit of competency.

Suggested Assessment Methods

For each unit of competency a number of assessment tools have been identified including:

- Work Projects
- Oral Questions
- Written Questions
- Third Party Statements
- Observation Checklists.

Instructions and Evidence Recording Sheets have been identified in this Assessment Manual for use by Assessors.

Alternative Assessment Methods

Whilst the above mentioned assessment methods are suggested assessment methods, the assessor may use an alternate method of assessment taking into account:

- a) The nature of the unit
- b) The strengths of participants
- c) The number of participants in the class
- d) Time required to complete assessments
- e) Time dedicated to assessment
- f) Equipment and resources required.

Alternate assessment methods include:

- Practical demonstrations
- Practical demonstrations in simulated work conditions
- Problem solving
- Portfolios of evidence
- Critical incident reports
- Journals
- Oral presentations
- Interviews
- Videos
- Visuals/slides/audiotapes

- Case studies
- Log books
- Projects and Role plays
- Group projects
- Recognition of Prior Learning.

Whilst there is no specific instruction or evidence collection documents for all the alternative assessment methods, assessors can record competency in the 'Other' section within the 'Competency Recording Sheet'.

Selection of Assessment Methods

Each assessor will determine the combination of Assessment Methods to be used to determine Competency for each Competency Unit on a student by student basis.

'Sufficient' evidence to support the 'Pass Competent'/'Not Yet Competent' decision must be captured.

In practice this means a minimum of 2 – 3 Assessment Methods for each candidate for each Competency Element is suggested.

At least one method should provide evidence of practical demonstration of competence.

The following assessment methods deemed to provide evidence of practical demonstration of competence include:

- Practical Work Projects
- Third Party Statement
- Observation Checklist.

Assessing Competency

Competency based assessment does not award grades, but simply identifies if the participant has the knowledge, skills and attitudes to undertake the required task to the specified standard.

Therefore, when assessing competency, an assessor has two possible results that can be awarded:

- 'Pass Competent' (PC)
- 'Not Yet Competent' (NYC).

Pass Competent (PC)

If the participant is able to successfully answer or demonstrate what is required, to the expected standards of the performance criteria, they will be deemed as 'Pass Competent' (PC).

The assessor will award a 'Pass Competent' (PC) if they feel the participant has the necessary knowledge, skills and attitudes in all assessment tasks for a unit.

Not Yet Competent' (NYC)

If the participant is unable to answer or demonstrate competency to the desired standard, they will be deemed to be 'Not Yet Competent' (NYC).

This does not mean the participant will need to complete all the assessment tasks again. The focus will be on the specific assessment tasks that were not performed to the expected standards.

The participant may be required to:

- a) Undertake further training or instruction
- b) Undertake the assessment task again until they are deemed to be 'Pass Competent'.

Regional Qualifications Framework and Skills Recognition System

The 'Regional Qualifications Framework and Skills Recognition System', also known as the 'RQFSRS' is the overriding educational framework for the ASEAN region.

The purpose of this framework is to provide:

- A standardised teaching and assessment framework
- Mutual recognition of participant achievement across the ASEAN region. This includes achievement in individual Units of Competency or qualifications as a whole.

The role of the 'RQFSRS' is to provide, ensure and maintain 'quality assurance' across all countries and educational providers across the ASEAN region

Recognition of Prior Learning (RPL)

Recognition of Prior Learning is the process that gives current industry professionals who do not have a formal qualification, the opportunity to benchmark their extensive skills and experience against the standards set out in each unit of competency/subject.

This process is a learning and assessment pathway which encompasses:

- Recognition of Current Competencies (RCC)
- Skills auditing
- Gap analysis and training
- Credit transfer.

Code of Practice for Assessors

This Code of Practice provides:

- Assessors with direction on the standard of practice expected of them
- Candidates with assurance of the standards of practice expected of assessors
- Employers with assurance of the standards maintained in the conduct of assessment.

The Code detailed below is based on the International Code of Ethics and Practice (The National Council for Measurement in Education [NCME]):

- The differing needs and requirements of the person being assessed, the local enterprise and/or industry are identified and handled with sensitivity
- Potential forms of conflict of interest in the assessment process and/or outcomes are identified and appropriate referrals are made, if necessary
- All forms of harassment are avoided throughout the planning, conducting, reviewing and reporting of the assessment outcomes

- The rights of the candidate are protected during and after the assessment
- Personal and interpersonal factors that are not relevant to the assessment of competency must not influence the assessment outcomes
- The candidate is made aware of rights and process of appeal
- Evidence that is gathered during the assessment is verified for validity, reliability, authenticity, sufficiency and currency
- Assessment decisions are based on available evidence that can be produced and verified by another assessor
- Assessments are conducted within the boundaries of the assessment system policies and procedures
- Formal agreement is obtained from both the candidate and the assessor that the assessment was carried out in accordance with agreed procedures
- The candidate is informed of all assessment reporting processes prior to the assessment
- The candidate is informed of all known potential consequences of decisions arising from an assessment, prior to the assessment
- Confidentiality is maintained regarding assessment results
- The assessment results are used consistently with the purposes explained to the candidate
- Opportunities are created for technical assistance in planning, conducting and reviewing assessment procedures and outcomes.

Instructions and Checklist for Assessors

Instructions

General instructions for the assessment:

- Assessment should be conducted at a scheduled time that has been notified to the candidate
- Facilitators must ensure participants are made aware of the need to complete assessments and attend assessment sessions
- If a participant is unable to attend a scheduled session, they must make arrangements with the Assessor to undertake the assessment at an alternative time
- At the end of the assessment the Assessor must give feedback and advise the participant on their PC/NYC status
- Complete the relevant documentation and submit to the appropriate department.

Preparation

- Gain familiarity with the Unit of Competency, Elements of Competency and the Performance Criteria expected
- Study details assessment documentation and requirements
- Brief candidate regarding all assessment criteria and requirements.

Briefing Checklist

- Begin the assessment by implementing the following checklist and then invite the candidate to proceed with assessment.

Checklist for Assessors

Prior to the assessment I have:	Tick (✓)	Remarks
Ensured the candidate is informed about the venue and schedule of assessment.		
Received current copies of the performance criteria to be assessed, assessment plan, evidence gathering plan, assessment checklist, appeal form and the company's standard operating procedures (SOP).		
Reviewed the performance criteria and evidence plan to ensure I clearly understood the instructions and the requirements of the assessment process.		
Identified and accommodated any special needs of the candidate.		
Checked the set-up and resources for the assessment.		
During the assessment I have:		
Introduced myself and confirmed identities of candidates.		
Put candidates at ease by being friendly and helpful.		
Explained to candidates the purpose, context and benefits of the assessment.		
Ensured candidates understood the assessment process and all attendant procedures.		
Provided candidates with an overview of performance criteria to be assessed.		
Explained the results reporting procedure.		
Encouraged candidates to seek clarifications if in doubt.		
Asked candidates for feedback on the assessment.		
Explained legal, safety and ethical issues, if applicable.		
After the assessment I have:		
Ensured candidate is given constructive feedback.		
Completed and signed the assessment record.		
Thanked candidate for participating in the assessment.		

Instructions for Recording Competency

Specifications for Recording Competency

The following specifications apply to the preparation of Evidence Gathering Plans:

- A Competency Recording Sheet must be prepared for each candidate to ensure and demonstrate all Performance Criteria and Competency Elements are appropriately assessed. This Sheet indicates how the Assessor will gather evidence during their assessment of each candidate
- This Competency Recording Sheet is located at the end of the Assessment Plan
- It is the overriding document to record competency
- The Assessor may vary the Competency Recording Sheet to accommodate practical and individual candidate and/or workplace needs
- Assessor must place a tick (✓) in the 'Assessment Method' columns to identify the methods of assessment to be used for each candidate
- Multiple Competency Elements/Performance Criteria may be assessed at the one time, where appropriate
- The assessor and participant should sign and date the Competency Recording Sheet, when all forms of evidence and assessment have been completed
- The assessor may provide and feedback or clarify questions which the participant may have in regards to the assessment grade or findings
- All documents used to capture evidence must be retained, and attached to the Competency Recording Sheet for each candidate for each Competency Unit.

Instructions for Different Assessment Methods

Specifications for Work Project Assessment

These guidelines concern the use of work projects.

The work projects identified in the Training Manuals involve a range of tasks, to be performed at the discretion of the Assessor.

Work project tasks can be completed through any form of assessment as identified in the Trainer and Trainee Manuals and stated at the start of this section.

Assessors should follow these guidelines:

- Review the Work Projects at the end of each 'Element of Competency' in the Trainee Manual to ensure you understand the content and what is expected
- Prepare sufficient resources for the completion of work activities including:
 - Time – whether in scheduled delivery hours or suggested time participants to spend outside of class hours
 - Resources – this may involve technical equipment, computer, internet access, stationery and other supplementary materials and documents
- Prepare assessment location (if done in class) making it conducive to assessment
- Explain Work Projects assessment to candidate, at the start of each Element of Competency. This ensures that participants are aware of what is expected and can collate information as delivery takes place

- Assessors can use the following phrase as a guide (where an 'X' is identified, please input appropriate information):
 "At the end of each Element of Competency there are Work Projects which must be completed. These projects require different tasks that must be completed.
 These work projects are part of the formal assessment for the unit of competency titled X:
- You are required to complete these activities:
 - Using the 'X' method of assessment*
 - At 'X' location*
 - You will have 'X time period' for this assessment*
 - You are required to compile information in a format that you feel is appropriate to the assessment
 - Do you have any questions about this assessment?"
- Commence Work Project assessment:
 - The assessor may give time for participants to review the questions at this time to ensure they understand the nature of the questions. The assessor may need to clarify questions
 - Participants complete work projects in the most appropriate format
 - Participants must submit Work Project evidence to the assessor before the scheduled due date
- Assessor must assess the participant's evidence against the competency standards specified in each Element of Competency and their own understanding. The assessor can determine if the participant has provided evidence to a 'competent' standard
- Transcribe results/details to Competency Recording Sheet
- Forward/file assessment record.

Specifications for Oral Question Assessment

These guidelines concern the use of oral questioning.

Assessors should follow these guidelines.

- Prepare Assessment Record for Oral Questioning. One record for each candidate:
 - Enter Student name
 - Enter Assessor name
 - Enter Location
- Familiarise self with Questions to be asked
- Prepare assessment location (table and chairs) making it conducive to assessment
- Explain Oral Questioning assessment to candidate, using the following phrase as a guide (where a 'X' is identified, please input appropriate information):
"These oral questions are part of the formal assessment for the unit of competency titled X.

There are X questions and you are required to answer all of them to the best of your ability and I will record whether or not you have answered correctly.

We have 60 minutes for this assessment.

- I will give you feedback at the end of the assessment
- Do you have any questions about this assessment?”
- Commence Oral Questioning assessment:
 - Complete Assessment Record for the Oral Questioning by:
 - a) Ticking PC or NYC, as appropriate
 - b) Entering ‘Remarks’ as required
 - c) Completing Oral Questioning within 60 minutes
- Complete Oral Questioning and provide feedback to candidate
- Transcribe results/details to Competency Recording Sheet
- Forward/file assessment record.

Specifications for Written Question Assessment

These guidelines concern the use of written questioning.

Assessors should follow these guidelines:

- Familiarise self with Questions and Answers provided
- Print and distribute copies of ‘Written Questions’ for participants. Ideally this should take place with adequate time for participants to answer all questions before the expected due date
- Explain Written Questioning assessment to candidate, using the following phrase as a guide (where a ‘X’ is identified, please input appropriate information):

“These written questions are part of the formal assessment for the unit of competency titled X.

There are X questions and you are required to answer all of them to the best of your ability.

You may refer to your subject materials, however where possible try to utilise your existing knowledge when answering questions.

Where you are unsure of questions, please ask the Assessor for further instruction. This may be answering the question orally or asking the assessor to redefine the question.

We have X time for this assessment:

- The due date for completion of this assessment is X
- On this date you must forward the completed questions to the assessor by X time on the date of X
- Do you have any questions about this assessment?”
- The assessor may give time for participants to review the questions at this time to ensure they understand the nature of the questions. The assessor may need to clarify questions
- Participants may record written answers (where possible)
- Participants must submit the written answers to the assessor before the scheduled due date

- Assessor must assess the participant's written answers against the model answers provided as a guide, or their own understanding. The assessor can determine if the participant has answered the questions to a 'competent' standard
- Transcribe results/details to Competency Recording Sheet
- Forward/file assessment record.

Specifications for Observation Checklist

These specifications apply to the use of the Observation Checklist in determining competency for candidates.

Only an approved assessor is authorised to complete the Observation Checklist.

The assessor is required to observe the participant, ideally in a simulated environment or their practical workplace setting and record their performance (or otherwise) of the competencies listed on the Observation Checklist for the Competency Unit.

To complete the Observation Checklist the Assessor must:

- Insert name of candidate
- Insert assessor name
- Insert identify of location where observations are being undertaken
- Insert date/s of observations – may be single date or multiple dates
- Place a tick in either the 'Yes' or 'No' box for each listed Performance Criteria to indicate the candidate has demonstrated/not demonstrated that skill
- Provide written (and verbal) feedback to candidate – as/if appropriate
- Sign and date the form
- Present form to candidate for them to sign and date
- Transcribe results/details to Competency Recording Sheet for candidate
- Forward/file Observation Checklist.

This source of evidence combines with other forms of assessment to assist in determining the 'Pass Competent' or 'Not Yet Competent' decision for the participant.

Specifications for Third Party Statement

These specifications relate to the use of a relevant workplace person to assist in determining competency for candidates.

The Third Party Statement is to be supplied by the assessor to a person in the workplace who supervises and/or works closely with the participant.

This may be their Supervisor, the venue manager, the Department Manager or similar.

The Third Party Statement asks the Supervisor to record what they believe to be the competencies of the participant based on their workplace experience of the participant. This experience may be gained through observation of their workplace performance, feedback from others, inspection of candidate's work etc.

A meeting must take place between the Assessor and the Third Party to explain and demonstrate the use of the Third Party Statement.

To complete the Third Party Verification Statement the Assessor must:

- Insert candidate name
- Insert name and contact details of the Third Party
- Tick the box to indicate the relationship of the Third Party to the candidate
- Present the partially completed form to the Third Party for them to finalise
- Collect the completed form from the Third Party
- Transcribe results/details to Competency Recording Sheet for candidate
- Forward/file Third Party Statement.

The Third Party must:

- Record their belief regarding candidate ability/competency as either:
 - Pass Competent = Yes
 - Not Yet Competent = No
 - Unsure about whether candidate is competent or not = Not Sure
- Meet briefly with the assessor to discuss and/or clarify the form.

This source of evidence combines with other forms of assessment to assist in determining the 'Pass Competent' or 'Not Yet Competent' decision for the candidate.

A separate Third Party Statement is required for each Competency Unit undertaken by the candidate.

Competency standard

UNIT TITLE: MANAGE AND MONITOR INNOVATIVE TOURISM PROGRAMS AND PROJECTS		NOMINAL HOURS: 60
UNIT NUMBER: D2.TGA.CL6.03 D2.TRM.CL9.10		
UNIT DESCRIPTOR: This unit deals with skills and knowledge required to administer innovative tourism and programs within a travel and tourism organisation		
ELEMENTS AND PERFORMANCE CRITERIA		UNIT VARIABLE AND ASSESSMENT GUIDE
Element 1: Plan the administration of the innovative tourism program/project 1.1 <i>Confirm the program/project</i> 1.2 <i>Identify factors affecting timelines for implementation</i> 1.3 <i>Develop program/project plans</i> 1.4 <i>Link budget to key outcomes</i> 1.5 <i>Identify monitoring and reporting arrangements</i> 1.6 <i>Allocate resources</i> 1.7 <i>Integrate program/plan with other initiatives</i> 1.8 <i>Confirm agreements with service providers</i> 1.9 <i>Develop contingency plans</i> 1.10 <i>Develop teams to support program/project implementation</i> 1.11 <i>Select program/project management tools</i>		Unit Variables The Unit Variables provide advice to interpret the scope and context of this unit of competence, allowing for differences between enterprises and workplaces. It relates to the unit as a whole and facilitates holistic assessment This unit applies to all industry sectors that are involved in the implementation of innovative tourism programs and projects within the labour divisions of the hotel and travel industries and may include: 1. Travel Agencies 2. Tour Operation <i>Confirm the program/project</i> may include: • Understanding the agreed details relating to the program/project in terms of: ▪ Purpose ▪ Scope ▪ Goals and objectives.

Element 2: Coordinate the administration of the innovative tourism program/project 2.1 <i>Allocate tasks and resources</i> 2.2 <i>Maintain financial control systems</i> 2.3 <i>Monitor program/project progress</i> 2.4 <i>Report program/project progress</i> 2.5 <i>Maintain program/project records</i> 2.6 <i>Manage start-up activities and manage project implementation</i> Element 3: Finalise the innovative tourism program/project 3.1 <i>Administer winding up activities for the program/project</i> 3.2 <i>Review program/project administration</i> 3.3 <i>Evaluate the program/project</i> 3.4 <i>Report on program/project administration and results</i>	<i>Factors affecting timelines for implementation</i> will include: • Legislated requirements • Contractual obligations • Activities of competitors • Economic imperatives • Integration with other programs/projects • Advertised timelines for availability/implementation • Weather and economic conditions. <i>Develop program/project plans</i> may be related to: • Identifying relevant acquisition strategies for materials, information and resources required for the program/project • Developing a specific budget and financial management strategy • Developing communication and contract management plans, where applicable • Generating details cost estimates • Preparing evaluation criteria for program/project progress and completion • Determining final expected outcomes and measurable benefits of the program/project • Developing intellectual property strategies, where applicable • Determining program/project milestones • Clarifying/revising program/project objectives and purpose, including confirming or clarifying the rationale for the program/project • Defining program/project deliverables and criteria for evaluating acceptance of same • Developing a human resource plan, where applicable, describing training, staff involved, time commitment, authority and communication structure
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- Developing performance indicators
 - Describing project control mechanisms
 - Developing program/project implementation and governance strategy
 - Defining quality assurance and quality control strategies for the program/project
 - Identifying program/project resource requirements, including human, physical and financial
 - Developing risk management protocols for the program/project
 - Defining relevant roles and responsibilities for those involved in the program/project
 - Deciding schedules and timelines
 - Defining tasks and activities
 - Coordinating staff
 - Preparing program/project-specific documentation
 - Processing income and payments relating to the program/project
 - Planning general and specific project activities
 - Planning administrative tasks specific to the program/project.
- Link budget to key outcomes should include:*
- Prioritising outcomes
 - Ensuring accountability and transparency
 - Ensuring all resource types are involved as required, such as human, physical and financial
 - Developing explanatory notes to supplement the allocation of resources.

	<i>Monitoring and reporting arrangements</i> may include: • Financial management arrangements • Record keeping • Reporting framework and schedule, including team reports • Project management software and other tools, such as Gantt and bar charts • Program Evaluation and Review Technique (PERT) • Critical Path Method • Cost schedule control system • Spreadsheets • Charts including project control chart, control point chart • Milestone chart and budget control chart • Defining report requirements, including contents, report structure and relevant timelines for report presentations. <i>Allocate resources</i> may include: • Establishing budgets • Establishing scopes of authority and discretionary powers relating to resources • Defining systems and procedures to guide the use and application of resources • Prioritising operational activities • Scheduling tasks and the overall workload for the program/project • Breaking tasks into sub-tasks • Arranging tasks into groups, where applicable • Facilitating team involvement in task and resources allocations
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	• Allocating responsibilities to align with resources provided • Delegating tasks • Imposing constraints and limitations on resource availability and usage • Establishing line/chain of command protocols for managing resource use between joint venture partners, including private and public sector funding sources, where applicable. <i>Integrate program/plan with other initiatives</i> may include: • Capitalising on economies of scale • Utilising staff with complementary skills, knowledge and experience in associated areas and disciplines • Minimising unnecessary duplication • Centralising operations to facilitate control and minimise expenditure. <i>Agreements with service providers</i> may include: • Legally contracted arrangements • Word-of-mouth agreements • Previous services provided by suppliers • Negotiating changes to existing arrangements • Clarifying issues • Establishing operational protocols to guide/control the integration of service providers into the program/project. <i>Develop contingency plans</i> may include: • Identifying situations that may require contingency management plans, including: ▪ Operational issues
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	▪ Time-related issues ▪ Changed marketplace conditions • Obtaining stakeholder agreement • Identifying trigger points for implementation • Developing contingency management structure, composition and policies • Writing and approving draft contingency management plans. <i>Teams to support program/project implementation may include:</i> • Determining structure and size of teams • Matching team skills to the identified program/project needs, objectives, purpose, and/or outcomes • Developing guidelines for team activities • Allocating responsibilities and tasks within the team(s) • Determining team communication and report strategies • Facilitating communication • Undertaking relevant team training. <i>Allocate tasks and resources may include:</i> • Complying with approved/established plans • Modifying allocations on the basis of extra funds available • Taking action to address changes in the operational and implementation context for the program/project • Communicating actions taken to the appropriate team members and relevant stakeholders
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	• Recording actions taken • Ensuring resource allocations align with established guidelines and accountability protocols • Ensuring transparency of relevant decision making processes and the expenditure of funds. <i>Maintain financial control systems may include:</i> • Entering data into established budgets • Approving expenditures • Obtaining necessary quotations for expenses over a designated amount • Verifying purchases, payments and products/services received • Auditing the books • Ensuring budgetary controls and guidelines are being met. <i>Report program/project progress may include:</i> • Supporting reports with fact-based evidence • Preparing written reports • Providing verbal presentation and explanations • Organising meetings with relevant stakeholders. <i>Manage start-up activities and manage project implementation may include:</i> • Refining project plans • Consulting with steering committees and other relevant stakeholders • Initiating and operating identified systems, procedures, processes, practices and policies • Facilitating operational and implementation understanding regarding the program/project
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	• Ensuring the requirements of all relevant plans are implemented as required and/or amended on the basis of feedback received and issues arising • Providing leadership and direction to team members • Responding appropriately to established system triggers as operational demands dictate • Soliciting input and feedback from team members and relevant stakeholders • Resolving disputes and disagreements relating to program/project implementation • Negotiating program/project change proposals throughout the life of the initiative • Apply consulting and reporting mechanisms. <i>Winding up activities</i> may include: • Inspection of the program/project deliverables • Testing operational capacity of the program/project deliverables • Evaluating the program/project deliverables against set criteria • Obtaining sign off on nominated aspects of the program/project • Finalising revenues promised to support the program/project • Finalising payments related to program/project expenditure • Undertaking internal and/or external auditing • Undertaking formal reporting procedures. <i>Review program/project administration</i> may include: • Reviewing the documentation that was used • Reviewing the systems and procedures developed • Reviewing the command, control and communication structure • Reviewing the input, contribution, cooperation and collaboration received from joint partners and contracted service providers.
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Evaluate the program/project may include:

- Evaluating the outcomes of the program/project
- Evaluating the contribution made by sub-systems that supported the development and implementation phases
- Identifying lessons for inclusion in subsequent management and monitoring activities relating to innovative tourism programs/projects
- Evaluating the potential for additional/follow-on innovative tourism programs/projects.

Assessment Guide

The following skills and knowledge must be assessed as part of this unit:

- Enterprise policies and procedures in regard to management and monitoring of innovative tourism activities, including allocation of resources, communication and control and protocols relating to the involvement of external third parties
- Principles of project management and implementation including planning and control techniques
- Ability to use planning and project management tools
- Knowledge of budgeting strategies for projects
- Ability to use communication, research, problem solving and innumeracy skills
- Ability to relate to people from a range of social, cultural and ethnic backgrounds
- Ability to produce and use project-related documentation
- Ability to allocate and coordinate the work of team members on the program/project
- Ability to monitor program/project implementation and respond effectively to issues arising throughout the life of the initiative
- Ability to oversee a program/project and deliver identified deliverable(s) on time and within budget.

	Linkages To Other Units • Access and retrieve computer-based data • Manage and resolve conflict situations • Work effectively with colleagues and customers • Work in a socially diverse environment • Establish and maintain a business relationship • Develop and implement a business plan • Develop new products and services • Produce documents, reports and worksheets on a computer • Manage and implement small projects • Plan and establish systems and procedures • Work cooperatively in a general administration environment • Develop and implement operational policies • Audit financial procedures • Manage financial performance within a budget • Manage legal requirements for business compliance • Provide professional support to business colleagues • Recruit and select staff • Develop and update tourism industry knowledge • Develop and implement operational plans • Manage operational risk • Monitor tourism operations
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- Construct and apply tourism product research
- Create, implement and evaluate strategic product initiatives
- Plan and implement sales activities
- Develop and manage business strategies
- Manage contractual agreements/commitments
- Manage and control operational costs
- Lead and manage a development team
- Source and package tourism products and services.

Critical Aspects of Assessment

Evidence of the following is essential:

- Understanding of host countries and/or enterprise policies and procedures in regard to management and monitoring of innovative tourism activities, including allocation of resources, communication and control and protocols relating to the involvement of external third parties
- Demonstrated ability to manage and monitor a nominated real or simulated innovative tourism program or project including:
 - Describing the context for the program/project
 - Developing a set of comprehensive, appropriate and detailed plans to guide program/project implementation
 - Providing and describing ongoing, day-to-day operational management of implementation of the program/project
 - Resolving issues arising during the course of the program/project
 - Maintaining an appropriate control system for all resources
 - Maintaining appropriate records in relation to program/project implementation
 - Providing copies of reports generated as part of the implementation process
 - Evaluating management and monitoring activities.

	Context of Assessment This unit may be assessed on or off the job: • Assessment should include practical demonstration either in the workplace or through a simulation activity, supported by a range of methods to assess underpinning knowledge • Assessment must relate to the individual's work area or area of responsibility. Resource Implications Training and assessment to include access to a real or simulated workplace; and access to workplace standards, procedures, policies, guidelines, tools and equipment. Assessment Methods The following methods may be used to assess competency for this unit: • Case studies • Observation of practical candidate performance • Oral and written questions • Analysis of portfolio of evidence, including plans, budgets, reports, feedback, program/project information, suggestions and recommendations • Problem solving • Role plays involving interaction with team members • Third party reports completed by a supervisor • Project and assignment work.
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	Key Competencies in this Unit <i>Level 1 = competence to undertake tasks effectively</i> <i>Level 2 = competence to manage tasks</i> <i>Level 3 = competence to use concepts for evaluating</i>		
	Key Competencies	Level	Examples
	Collecting, organising and analysing information	3	Capture information to use as the basis for the development of plans
	Communicating ideas and information	3	Share objectives, outcomes and responsibilities with team members
	Planning and organising activities	3	Schedule implementation and monitor activities
	Working with others and in teams	3	Collaborate with internal staff and external providers to deliver the required outcomes
	Using mathematical ideas and techniques	3	Calculate resource requirements and monitor resource usage
	Solving problems	3	Address issues arising throughout the life/implementation of the program/project
	Using technology	3	Use software programs to manage the project

Oral questions

Student name	
Assessor name	
Location/venue	
Unit of competency	Manage and monitor innovative tourism programs and projects D2.TGA.CL6.03 D2.TRM.CL9.10
Instructions	1. Ask student questions from the attached list to confirm knowledge, as necessary 2. Place tick in boxes to reflect student achievement (Pass Competent 'PC' or Not Yet Competent 'NYC') 3. Write short-form student answer in the space provided for each question.

Questions	Response	
	PC	NYC
1. What is an example of an innovative tourism project or program that has been undertaken in your region? What makes it innovative?	☐	☐
2. What are examples of 'legal' factors that may impact on the implementation of a tourism project or program?	☐	☐

Questions	Response	
	PC	NYC
3. What information is included in a project/program plan?	☐	☐
4. Why is it important to develop project/program budgets?	☐	☐
5. What are the aims of monitoring project activities?	☐	☐

Questions	Response	
	PC	NYC
6. What are examples of resources that can be used in tourism projects/programs?	☐	☐
7. Why is it important to integrate tourism projects/programs with other business activities?	☐	☐
8. Describe an occasion where you would need to get 'community approval' for a tourism project/ program. How would you get this approval?	☐	☐

Questions	Response	
	PC	NYC
9. What is the purpose of a contingency plan?	☐	☐
10. How can you identify possible learning and development needs for team members for tourism projects/programs?	☐	☐
11. What are two types of project management tools you can use to help plan and manage project implementation?	☐	☐

Questions	Response	
	PC	NYC
12. What are considerations when implementing projects/programs?	☐	☐
13. What financial aspects of a project/program need to be monitored?	☐	☐
14. Why is it important to monitor the progress of projects/programs?	☐	☐

Questions	Response	
	PC	NYC
15. What methods can be used to share project progress information with stakeholders?	☐	☐
16. What types of documents can be used in the planning or management of programs?	☐	☐
17. What are examples of predictable consequences of implementing new projects?	☐	☐

Questions	Response	
	PC	NYC
18. What activities are associated with re-allocating project team staff after the conclusion of a project/program?	☐	☐
19. What activities are associated with reviewing project/program administration?	☐	☐
20. What is the difference between 'reviewing' and 'evaluating' project performance and success?	☐	☐

Questions	Response	
	PC	NYC
21. What are types of recommendations that can be made when reporting poor project performance to stakeholders?	☐	☐

Written questions

Manage and monitor innovative tourism programs and projects – D2.TGA.CL6.03
D2.TRM.CL9.10

Student Name: _____

Answer all the following questions and submit to your Trainer.

1. What are three examples of types of tourism projects or programs?

2. What are two reasons for possible tourism projects or programs?

3. What are three factors affecting timelines for project implementation?

4. What criteria may be used to identify the feasibility for new projects and programs?

5. What is the importance of developing tourism projects and program plans?

6. What are three examples associated with developing project and program plans?

7. Why is it vital to link project/program budgets to key objectives?

8. What are three examples of expenses associated with projects/programs?

9. What are examples of monitoring and reporting arrangements used for projects/programs?

10. What areas of a project can you evaluate?

11. What are two examples of activities associated with allocating resources for a project/program?

12. What are internal factors affecting project resources?

13. What are examples of other business activities that tourism projects/programs must integrate with?

14. What are the benefits of integrating tourism projects/programs with other business activities?

15. What are types of agreements/activities you may confirm with service suppliers?

16. What are common contingencies to be addressed when planning contingency plans for tourism projects/programs?

17. What aspects would you need to confirm when designing team structure for projects / programs?

18. What are three types of learning and development activities that team members can undertake?

19. What is a Gantt chart? How is it useful in project planning?

20. What types of information regarding the 'overall project/program' would you need to communicate with team members?

21. What types of information regarding the 'individual responsibilities and tasks' would you need to communicate with team members?

22. What are two financial control activities?

23. What are examples of methods that can be used to monitor the progress of projects/programs?

24. What are two activities associated with reporting project progress?

25. What decisions need to be made when preparing report documents?

26. What are activities associated with allocating tasks and resources?

27. What are the steps involved in finalising and 'winding up' a project?

28. When would you conduct project/program reviews?

29. What are two aims of evaluating success of project / program?

30. What information would you report to stakeholders at the conclusion of a project/program?

Answers to written questions

Manage and monitor innovative tourism programs and projects – D2.TGA.CL6.03
D2.TRM.CL9.10

The following are model answers only – Trainers/Assessors must use discretion when determining whether or not an answer provided by a Student is acceptable or not.

1. What are three examples of types of tourism projects or programs?

- Development of towns, locations and attractions to support tourism
- Development of tourism infrastructure - including transportation, roads, airports, electricity, water etc
- Creating new tourism-related businesses - including accommodation, shops, entertainment
- Development of tourism related education and training
- Developing tourism infrastructure
- Promoting tourism for the country or region
- Preserving, rehabilitating or expanding tourism attractions
- Development of eco-tourism initiatives
- Conservation of local community wildlife
- Development of local conservation projects
- Development of sustainability projects
- Developing tourism policies and procedures
- Developing tourism activities and events
- Conducting tourism research projects
- Conducting environmental assessments
- Developing local communities
- Developing awareness of local community issues
- Conduct fundraising campaigns.

2. What are two reasons for possible tourism projects or programs?

- Changes in customer expectations
- Substandard products
- Marketing
- Opportunity / commercial potential
- Changes in local and global economic conditions
- Strategic directions of local communities or individual tourism organisation
- Inability to service current demand
- Inappropriate operating practices for the current market place and visitors
- Visitor expectation levels below acceptable levels
- Visible destruction of local environment and habitat resulting from tourism operations
- Increase in conflict within local community resulting from increased tourism activity
- Lack of resources for service delivery.

3. What are three factors affecting timelines for project implementation?

- Economic factors
- Environmental factors
- Technological factors
- Political factors
- Social factors
- Legal factors
- Competitive factors
- Contractual obligations
- Integration with other programs and projects
- Advertised timelines for availability or implementation
- Weather and seasonality factors.

4. What criteria may be used to identify the feasibility for new projects and programs?

- Achievement of established objectives
- Availability of resources and equipment
- Code of ethics
- Cost effectiveness
- Fulfilment of purpose
- Impact to organisation
- Innovativeness of ideas or concepts
- Level of risk
- Level of skill, and understanding required for implementation
- Potential benefits
- Suitability for target clients
- Technical feasibility
- Time needed to realise concept.

5. What is the importance of developing tourism projects and program plans?

- Identifies all activities in a logical and sequential order
- Provides a clear outline of the project activities
- Provides a constant reference point
- Facilitates the sharing of the plan
- Forces all or more planning considerations to be undertaken
- Allows for informed feedback in relation to the plan.

6. What are three examples associated with developing project and program plans?

- Identifying relevant acquisition strategies for materials, information and resources
- Developing a specific budget and financial management strategy
- Developing communication and contract management plans
- Generating details cost estimates
- Preparing evaluation criteria for program/project progress and completion
- Determining final expected outcomes and measurable benefits
- Developing intellectual property strategies
- Determining milestones
- Clarifying objectives and purpose
- Defining deliverables and criteria for evaluating acceptance of same
- Developing a human resource plan
- Developing performance indicators
- Describing project control mechanisms
- Developing implementation and governance strategy
- Defining quality assurance and quality control strategies
- Identifying resource requirements
- Developing risk management protocols
- Defining relevant roles and responsibilities for those involved
- Deciding schedules and timelines
- Defining tasks and activities
- Coordinating staff
- Preparing program/project-specific documentation
- Processing income and payments relating to the program/project
- Planning general and specific project activities
- Planning administrative tasks.

7. Why is it vital to link project/program budgets to key objectives?

- Prioritising outcomes
- Ensuring accountability and transparency
- Ensuring all resource types are involved as required, such as human, physical and financial
- Developing explanatory notes to supplement the allocation of resources.

8. What are three examples of expenses associated with projects/programs?

- Materials
- Employees
- Equipment
- Contracted labour
- Compensation
- Products
- Rent
- Advertising
- Insurance
- Office expenses
- Maintenance
- Capital expenditures.

9. What are examples of monitoring and reporting arrangements used for projects/programs?

- Financial management arrangements
- Record keeping
- Reporting framework and schedule, including team reports
- Project management software and other tools, such as Gantt and bar charts
- Program Evaluation and Review Technique (PERT)
- Critical Path Method
- Cost schedule control system
- Spreadsheets
- Charts including project control chart, control point chart
- Milestone chart and budget control chart
- Defining report requirements.

10. What areas of a project can you evaluate?

- The procedures or systems
- The workflow and workload for staff
- Whether or not there are gaps or overlaps in service provision
- The time it takes to do a task or job
- Job design
- Level of customer satisfaction with the service or product provided
- Cost
- Level of interest created and demand patterns
- Ease of implementation
- Increase in sales or leads
- Return on investment.

11. What are two examples of activities associated with allocating resources for a project/program?

- Establishing budgets
- Establishing scopes of authority and discretionary powers relating to resources
- Defining systems and procedures to guide the use and application of resources
- Prioritising operational activities
- Scheduling tasks and the overall workload for the program/project
- Breaking tasks into sub-tasks
- Arranging tasks into groups, where applicable
- Facilitating team involvement in task and resources allocations
- Allocating responsibilities to align with resources provided
- Delegating tasks
- Imposing constraints and limitations on resource availability and usage
- Establishing line/chain of command protocols.

12. What are internal factors affecting project resources?

- Nature of the project or program
- Project activities
- Directions the business wishes to take
- Target markets
- Service levels and standards
- Services and products provided
- Equipment used
- The existing reputation and image of the business
- Budget
- Existing resources
- Volume of customers
- Promises made.

13. What are examples of other business activities that tourism projects/programs must integrate with?

- Normal operational activities
- Marketing
- Special promotions
- Events
- Training and development initiatives
- Refurbishments or upgrading of resources
- Other programs or projects.

14. What are the benefits of integrating tourism projects/programs with other business activities?

- Capitalising on economies of scale
- Utilising staff with complementary skills, knowledge and experience in associated areas and disciplines
- Minimising unnecessary duplication
- Centralising operations to facilitate control and minimise expenditure.

15. What are types of agreements/activities you may confirm with service suppliers?

- Legally contracted arrangements
- Word-of-mouth agreements
- Previous services provided by suppliers
- Negotiating changes to existing arrangements
- Clarifying issues
- Establishing operational protocols to guide/control the integration of service providers into the program/project.

16. What are common contingencies to be addressed when planning contingency plans for tourism projects/programs?

- Unsuccessful activities
- Substandard work performed by contractors
- Inability of service providers to provide products and services
- Terrorism
- Economic collapse
- Faults and malfunctions occur with significant organisational equipment and systems
- Adverse weather conditions
- Changes to bookings
- Labour disputes
- Funding shortfalls
- Data loss
- Loss of a major client
- Power failure
- Loss or absence of key staff
- Death of customer.

17. What aspects would you need to confirm when designing team structure for projects / programs?

- Structure of the team
- Possible positions and titles
- Lines of authority, responsibility and communication
- Key responsibilities and tasks for each position
- Size of teams for each position
- Selecting appropriate persons by matching team skills to the identified program/project needs, objectives, purpose or outcomes.

18. What are three types of learning and development activities that team members can undertake?

- Lecture / Tutorial
- Demonstration
- Group Discussions
- Role Play
- Simulation Games
- Individual /Group Exercises
- Case Study
- Field Visit
- Group Presentation
- Practice Sessions
- Games
- Research Activities
- Qualifications and certified training programs
- Specialised programs
- Conferences
- Seminars
- Meetings
- Exhibitions
- Trade presentations
- Symposiums
- Agencies.

19. What is a Gantt chart? How is it useful in project planning?

It is a type of bar chart that illustrates a project schedule. Gantt charts illustrate the start and finish dates of the terminal elements and summary elements of a project.

20. What types of information regarding the 'overall project/program' would you need to communicate with team members?

- The nature of the project/program
- Purpose of the project/program
- Background information resulting in the creation of the project/program
- Objectives of the project/program
- Overall implementation strategy
- Outline of the project/program activities
- Timelines for completion
- Communication channels
- Project expectations.

21. What types of information regarding the 'individual responsibilities and tasks' would you need to communicate with team members?

- Structure of the project time
- Level of responsibility and authority
- Start dates of change
- Expected completion date
- Pre-change activities including attending meetings, reading job descriptions etc
- Activities to be performed
- Resources required to implement the plan
- Work breakdown
- Involvement of other staff
- Training to be taken
- Support mechanisms
- Expected standard of performance
- Milestones for completion
- Budgets to work within
- Methods of communication
- Making observations
- Providing feedback.

22. What are two financial control activities?

- Entering data into established budgets
- Approving expenditures
- Obtaining necessary quotations for expenses over a designated amount
- Verifying purchases, payments and products/services received
- Auditing the books
- Ensuring budgetary controls and guidelines are being met.

23. What are examples of methods that can be used to monitor the progress of projects/programs?

- Reading and analysing information sourced
- Reports
- Obtaining customer feedback
- Using a pretend customer
- Walking about observing what takes place and how it could be improved, what could be improved
- Use of checklists
- Brainstorming sessions
- Project team members input and review
- Checking of documentation
- Interviews with stakeholders
- Surveys
- Focus group interviews
- Discuss progress
- Solicited and unsolicited feedback
- Research on existing projects
- Organisational reviews
- Workforce management data
- Statistical data
- Comparisons with Key performance indicators
- Surveys
- Flowcharts
- Benchmarking
- Verifying time sheets
- Gap analysis
- Compliance reports

- QC 7 Tools
- Management and Planning Tools
- Tree Diagram Problem Solving Models
- RATER model.

24. What are two activities associated with reporting project progress?

- Supporting reports with fact-based evidence
- Preparing written reports
- Providing verbal presentation and explanations
- Organising meetings with relevant stakeholders.

25. What decisions need to be made when preparing report documents?

- The types of reports to be prepared
- What information is to be included in reports
- Who is to prepare reports
- The frequency with which reports are to be generated and disseminated
- The distribution list of who will receive these reports
- The method that will be used to disseminate the reports.

26. What are activities associated with allocating tasks and resources?

- Complying with approved/established plans
- Modifying allocations on the basis of extra funds available
- Taking action to address changes in the operational and implementation context for the program/project
- Communicating actions taken to the appropriate team members and relevant stakeholders
- Recording actions taken
- Ensuring resource allocations align with established guidelines and accountability protocols
- Ensuring transparency of relevant decision making processes and the expenditure of funds.

27. What are the steps involved in finalising and 'winding up' a project?

- Inspection of the program/project deliverables
- Testing operational capacity of the program/project deliverables
- Evaluating the program/project deliverables against set criteria
- Obtaining sign off on nominated aspects of the program/project
- Collecting feedback from stakeholders
- Finalising revenues promised to support the program/project
- Finalising payments related to program/project expenditure
- Re-allocation of project team staff
- Finalise accounting documentation.

28. When would you conduct project/program reviews?

- Quarterly reviews
- At the end of key activities
- Scheduled project milestones
- Performance reports
- Major events triggering a review
- At the conclusion of a project / program.

29. What are two aims of evaluating success of project / program?

Aims of evaluating success of a project or program include:

- Identify the actual progress against original project objectives
- Identify the overall success of the project or program
- Identifying areas which are being done well and rewarding accordingly
- Identifying where areas where the project or future projects can be improved through:
- Identify the need for the project to continue, it is current or varied form
- Identify the impact and value the project or program has provided.

30. What information would you report to stakeholders at the conclusion of a project/program?

- Explaining if your project strategy and effort work
 - Identifying the reasons why they work or not work
 - Significant variations and the factors associated with the changes
 - Unusual results and determine their causes
 - Strengths and marketing opportunities
 - Weaknesses and potential areas of improvement
 - Impact / implications of the results and conclusions on performance.
-

Observation checklist

Student name	
Assessor name	
Location/venue	
Unit of competency	Manage and monitor innovative tourism programs and projects D2.TGA.CL6.03 D2.TRM.CL9.10
Dates of observation	
Instructions	- Over a period of time observe the student completing each of the following tasks: - Plan the administration of the innovative tourism program/project - Coordinate the administration of the innovative tourism program/project - Finalise the innovative tourism program/project - Enter the date on which the tasks were undertaken - Place a tick in the box to show they completed each aspect of the task to the standard expected in the enterprise - Complete the feedback sections of the form, if required.

Did the candidate	Yes	No
Element 1: Plan the administration of the innovative tourism program/project		
Confirm the program/project	☐	☐
Identify factors affecting timelines for implementation	☐	☐
Develop program/project plans	☐	☐
Link budget to key outcomes	☐	☐
Identify monitoring and reporting arrangements	☐	☐
Allocate resources	☐	☐
Integrate program/plan with other initiatives	☐	☐
Confirm agreements with service providers	☐	☐
Develop contingency plans	☐	☐
Develop teams to support program/project implementation	☐	☐
Select program/project management tools	☐	☐

Did the candidate	Yes	No
Element 2: Coordinate the administration of the innovative tourism program/project		
Allocate tasks and resources	☐	☐
Maintain financial control systems	☐	☐
Monitor program/project progress	☐	☐
Report program/project progress	☐	☐
Maintain program/project records	☐	☐
Manage start-up activities and manage project implementation	☐	☐
Element 3: Finalise the innovative tourism program/project		
Administer winding up activities for the program/project	☐	☐
Review program/project administration	☐	☐
Evaluate the program/project	☐	☐
Report on program/project administration and results	☐	☐
Did the student's overall performance meet the standard?	☐	☐

Feedback to student and trainer/assessor**Strengths:****Improvements needed:****General comments:****Candidate signature****Date****Assessor signature****Date**

Third Party Statement

Student name:			
Name of third party:		Contact no:	
Relationship to student:	☐ Employer ☐ Supervisor ☐ Colleague ☐ Other Please specify: _____ Please do not complete the form if you are a relative, close friend or have a conflict of interest]		
Unit of competency:	Manage and monitor innovative tourism programs and projects D2.TGA.CL6.03 D2.TRM.CL9.10		
The student is being assessed against industry competency standards and we are seeking your support in the judgement of their competence. Please answer these questions as a record of their performance while working with you. Thank you for your time.			
Do you believe the trainee has demonstrated the following skills? <i>(tick the correct response)</i>	Yes	No	Not sure
Element 1: Plan the administration of the innovative tourism program/project			
Confirm the program/project	☐	☐	☐
Identify factors affecting timelines for implementation	☐	☐	☐
Develop program/project plans	☐	☐	☐
Link budget to key outcomes	☐	☐	☐
Identify monitoring and reporting arrangements	☐	☐	☐
Allocate resources	☐	☐	☐
Integrate program/plan with other initiatives	☐	☐	☐
Confirm agreements with service providers	☐	☐	☐
Develop contingency plans	☐	☐	☐
Develop teams to support program/project implementation	☐	☐	☐
Select program/project management tools	☐	☐	☐

Do you believe the trainee has demonstrated the following skills? <i>(tick the correct response)</i>	Yes	No	Not sure
Element 2: Coordinate the administration of the innovative tourism program/project			
Allocate tasks and resources	☐	☐	☐
Maintain financial control systems	☐	☐	☐
Monitor program/project progress	☐	☐	☐
Report program/project progress	☐	☐	☐
Maintain program/project records	☐	☐	☐
Manage start-up activities and manage project implementation	☐	☐	☐
Element 3: Finalise the innovative tourism program/project			
Administer winding up activities for the program/project	☐	☐	☐
Review program/project administration	☐	☐	☐
Evaluate the program/project	☐	☐	☐
Report on program/project administration and results	☐	☐	☐

Comments/feedback from Third Party to Trainer/Assessor:**Third party signature:****Date:****Send to:**

Competency recording sheet

Name of Student		
Name of Assessor/s		
Unit of Competency	Manage and monitor innovative tourism programs and projects	D2.TGA.CL6.03 D2.TRM.CL9.10
Date assessment commenced		
Date assessment finalised		
Assessment decision	Pass Competent / Not Yet Competent (Circle one)	
Follow up action required (Insert additional work and assessment required to achieve competency)		
Comments/observations by assessor/s		

Place a tick (✓) in the column to reflect evidence obtained to determine Competency of the student for each Performance Criteria.

Element & Performance Criteria	Observation of skills	3rd Party Statement	Oral Questions	Written Questions	Work Projects	Other
Element 1: Plan the administration of the innovative tourism program/project						
Confirm the program/project						
Identify factors affecting timelines for implementation						
Develop program/project plans						
Link budget to key outcomes						
Identify monitoring and reporting arrangements						
Allocate resources						
Integrate program/plan with other initiatives						
Confirm agreements with service providers						
Develop contingency plans						
Develop teams to support program/project implementation						
Select program/project management tools						

Place a tick (✓) in the column to reflect evidence obtained to determine Competency of the student for each Performance Criteria.

Element & Performance Criteria	Observation of skills	3rd Party Statement	Oral Questions	Written Questions	Work Projects	Other
Element 2: Coordinate the administration of the innovative tourism program/project						
Allocate tasks and resources						
Maintain financial control systems						
Monitor program/project progress						
Report program/project progress						
Maintain program/project records						
Manage start-up activities and manage project implementation						
Element 3: Finalise the innovative tourism program/project						
Administer winding up activities for the program/project						
Review program/project administration						
Evaluate the program/project						
Report on program/project administration and results						
Candidate signature:			Date:			
Assessor signature:			Date:			

